Cheng Chen

Prospective PhD/Master Applicant

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Major rank 3/87
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Application Strengths

- Tongji University undergraduate in Communication Engineering, major rank **3/87**, with a consistent research line in multimodal intelligence, trustworthy reasoning, deployable AI, and wireless intelligence.
- Research outputs: **IJCAI 2026** accepted co-first work; two **ACM MM 2026** submissions with initial scores **4/4/4/4/3** and **4/4/3/2**; accepted corresponding-author papers at **IJCNN 2026** and **ICANN 2026**; first-author submissions under review at **NeurIPS 2026** and **IEEE Wireless Communications Letters**.
- Research interests: multimodal understanding, trustworthy and deployable AI, model compression, and wireless intelligence, with emphasis on clear problems, rigorous evaluation, and real deployment constraints.

Education

B.Eng. in Communication Engineering, Tongji University, Shanghai, China — 2023.09 – Present
Major rank: **3/87**; CET-6: **519**.
Selected coursework: Data Structures and Algorithms, Digital Signal Processing, Probability and Statistics, Signals and Systems, Digital Electronics, Information Theory, Computer Networks, Embedded Systems.

Research Outputs

OrthKD: Extracting Generalized Clinical Knowledge from Heterogeneous Teachers for Lightweight Deployment — IJCAI 2026
C. Chen*, Y. Xu*, and M. Cao. **Accepted; co-first author.**
Proposes orthogonal distillation for heterogeneous clinical teachers, separating transferable knowledge from teacher-specific bias for lightweight deployment.

Open-Vocabulary Audio-Visual Event Localization / Transferable Visual Attack Studies — ACM MM 2026
Under review at ACM MM 2026; co-first author / first author; initial scores: 4/4/4/4/3 (approx. top 5%) and 4/4/3/2 (approx. top 15–20%).
Studies open-vocabulary audio-visual localization and transferable deformation attacks, emphasizing cross-modal grounding, reliability, and robustness evaluation.

Enabling Visual Reasoning in Text-Only LLMs via Symbolic Scene Descriptions — IJCNN 2026
W. Lei, M. Cao, C. Ye, Y. Xu, and **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Encodes visual scenes as symbolic descriptions so text-only LLMs can reason from structured perception outputs.

Beyond Relevance: Counter-Evidence Planning in a Controlled Budgeted RAG Testbed — ICANN 2026
Y. Cai, Y. Xu, and **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Studied counter-evidence planning for fixed-budget RAG and reliability-oriented retrieval decisions.

Neural-Operator Risk Assessment for Deployable Risk Triage — NeurIPS 2026
Under review at NeurIPS 2026; first author.
Studies single-pass risk triage for neural operators, targeting early warning, calibration, and low-overhead deployment.

Learning-Aided Privacy Beamforming for ISAC — IEEE WCL
Under review at IEEE Wireless Communications Letters; first author.
Studies privacy-aware beamforming under eavesdropper location uncertainty.

Competitions & Awards

National Second Prize, Global Campus Artificial Intelligence Algorithm Elite Competition — 2025
National Third Prize, National College Students' Embedded Systems Competition — 2025

Research Skills

- **Problem formulation and method design:** experience in knowledge distillation, audio-visual localization, reliable RAG, risk triage, and privacy-aware beamforming; able to align task assumptions, evaluation protocols, and deployment constraints.
- **Experimental evaluation:** PyTorch training and evaluation, baseline reproduction, ablation design, calibration/robustness analysis, and error-case diagnosis, with emphasis on claim-evidence consistency.
- **Academic writing and collaboration:** English paper writing, LaTeX figures/tables, and submission materials; contributed method design, experiments, and revisions across first-author, co-first-author, and corresponding-author work.